

# Samuel R. Absher

## Curriculum vitae

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Citizenship: United States

### Employment

- 2025 – Senior Consultant, Research & Planning Consultants, LP
- 2022 – 2025 Faculty, RAND School of Public Policy
- 2019 – 2025 Associate Economist, RAND
- 2018 – 2019 Postdoctoral Researcher, Free Market Institute at Texas Tech University

### Education

- 2018 Ph.D. Economics, University of Oklahoma.  
Dissertation: *Three Essays in Development and Applied Micro*, advisor Kevin Grier
- 2013 B.A. Economics, University of Oklahoma

### Skills

R (including sf/ggplot2 for spatial analysis and mapping), Stata, SQL, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X; LLM-assisted research workflows

### Research

Interests: causal inference (regression discontinuity, instrumental variables, difference-in-differences, synthetic control), economics of science and technology, labor economics, public economics, political economy, health economics

#### Journal Articles

- 2023 **Absher, Samuel R.**, Kevin Grier, and Robin Grier. The consequences of CIA-sponsored regime change in Latin America. *European Journal of Political Economy* 80.
- 2020 **Absher, Samuel R.**, Kevin Grier, and Robin Grier. The economic consequences of durable left-populist regimes in Latin America. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* 177. (1): 787–817.
- 2018 **Absher, Samuel R.**, Kevin Grier, and Bob Lawson. You say you want a (Rose) Revolution? The effects of Georgia’s 2004 market reforms. *Economics of Transition and Institutional Change* 27. (1): 301–323.

#### Reports

- 2025 Beth J. Asch, Michael G. Mattock, Jason M. Ward, **Samuel Absher**, Patricia K. Tong, Anton Shenk. *A Review of the Military Basic Pay Table*. RRA2400-1.
- 2025 Beth J. Asch, Jason M. Ward, **Samuel Absher**. *Reassessing the Basic Allowance for Housing for Army Personnel in a Rapidly Changing Housing Market*. RR-A2412-1.
- 2024 Avery Calkins, **Samuel Absher**, Paul Emslie, Catria Gadwah-Meaden, Ashley Gromis, Thomas Light, et al. *Recruiter Management in the Department of the Air Force*. RR-A2181-1.

- 2023 Stephen Watts, Angela O'Mahoney, Bryan Rooney, Maggie Habib, Patrick Mills, **Samuel Absher**, Hitoshi Kumagai. *Assessing the Value of Overseas Military Campaigning in Strategic Competition*. RR-A1798-1.
- 2023 Jason M. Ward, Jeffrey B. Wenger, Irineo Cabrerros, Daniel Schwam, Craig A. Bond, **Samuel Absher**. *A Revised Recruiting Resource Model for Achieving the Army Personnel Strategy: Accounting for Digital Advertising*. RR-A2108-1.
- 2023 **Absher, Samuel R.** and Jennifer Kavanagh. *The Impact of State Voting Processes in the 2020 Election: Estimating the Effects on Voter Turnout, Voting Method, and the Spread of COVID-19*. RR-A112-25.
- 2022 Jon Schmid, Bonnie L. Triezenberg, James Dimarogonas, **Samuel Absher**. *The Role of Standards in Fostering Capability Evolution: Does Design Matter? Insights from Interoperability Standards*. RR-A1576-1.
- 2021 Jennifer Kavanagh, **Samuel Absher**, Nathan Chandler, Ariana Tabatabai, Jeffrey Martini, Sebastian Bae, Hannah Bryne, Michael Shurkin. *Building Military Coalitions: Lessons from U.S. Experience*. RR-A859-1.
- 2021 Timothy M. Bonds, James Bonomo, Daniel Gonzales, C Richard Neu, **Samuel Absher**, Edward Parker, Spencer Pfiefer, Jen Brooks, Julia Brackup, Jordan Wilcox, Dave Frelinger, Anita Szafran. *America's 5G Era: Gaining Competitive Advantages While Securing the Country and Its People*. PE-A435-1.

### Working Papers

- 2026 **Absher, Samuel R.**, Kevin Grier, and Robin Grier. Fences and Fortunes: The Local Effects of US Border Enforcement Policy. Under review.
- 2023 **Absher, Samuel R.** and Kevin Grier. Mobile phones and collective violent action: Evidence from the Libyan Revolution. Working Paper.
- 2019 **Absher, Samuel R.** The persistent effects of military violence against civilians: A geographic regression discontinuity analysis of the Soviet occupation in East Germany. Working Paper.

### Work in Progress

**Absher, Samuel R.**, Jason Ward, and Sussha Roy. Willingness to pay for school quality: An application of spatial first differences.

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### Affiliations

- 2018 – Member, American Economic Association
- 2021 – 2025 Core Member, Center for Causal Inference at RAND
- 2025 – Member, American Society of Health Economists

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### Awards

- 2025 RAND Gold Medal Award
- 2025 RAND Spotlight Award
- 2016 Chong Liew Summer Research Award

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## Invited Presentations

- 2023 Free Market Institute at Texas Tech University
- 2019 Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC) Conference
- 2019 56th Annual Meetings of the Public Choice Society
- 2018 Southern Economic Association (SEA) 88th Annual Meetings
- 2016 Southern Economic Association (SEA) 86th Annual Meetings

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## Teaching

### Courses prepared to teach

Econometrics, statistics, development economics, cost-benefit and cost-effectiveness analysis, microeconomics

### Experience

- 2023 – 2024 Primary Instructor for *Microeconomic Theory I – Policy and Economic Systems*, RAND School of Public Policy
- 2023 – 2024 Primary Instructor for *Understanding Economic Systems I*, RAND School of Public Policy
- 2022 – 2024 Primary Instructor for *Cost Benefit and Cost Effectiveness Analysis*, RAND School of Public Policy
- 2017 – 2018 Primary Instructor for *Elements of Statistics*, Economics Department, University of Oklahoma
- 2014 – 2018 Teaching Assistant, Economics Department, University of Oklahoma.

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## Professional Service

### Referee

*Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*

*Journal of Economic Growth*

*Public Choice*

*Journal of Peace Research*

*Economics of Transition & Institutional Change*

### Technical review

- 2020 National Collaborative on Gun Violence Research

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## Other Credentials

Security Clearance: U.S. Census Bureau Special Sworn Status.